

How could we help the recently moved first year students, who don't use social media due to fear of privacy, learn how to change a superficial connection into a deep one in order to maintain and deepen their connection without too much of an effort.

Introduction

Dear reader, have you ever felt like you are missing a connection with someone? The problem isn't talking to them, but you don't know how to get together and truly get to know each other? We get that, and we wanted to fix that.

We: Dvir, Elisheva, Mandy, Niv and Thomas are Elco. Elco focuses on the phenomenon of loneliness among Generation Z. This phenomenon is mostly created due to prolonged sitting in closed places and making connections mainly through social networks and screens. It creates emotional distress, anxiety, communication difficulties and a sense of separation from the environment. Over the past few days we have been working on a tool that helps people connect with each other.

Research evidence illustrates that physical activity, and associated processes, can contribute positively to mental health (with the obvious exceptions of over-training and training addiction) and have a positive effect on anxiety, depression, mood and emotion, self-esteem and psychological dysfunction Mutrie, N., & Biddle, S. J. H., 1995. Therefore we took it upon ourselves to make it available for everyone.

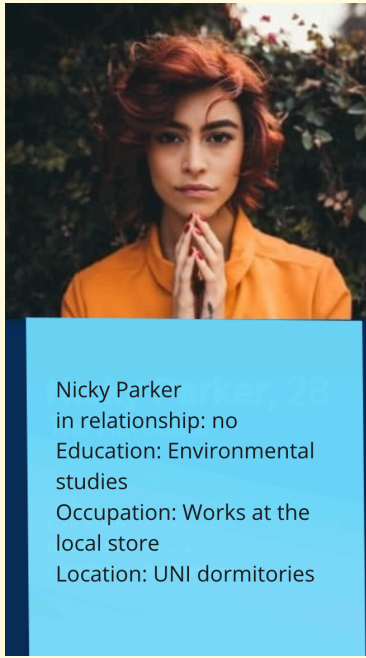
Please start by reading our methods before going to the results, everything is supported with information you can find under 'statistics' and the general conclusion will wrap everything up. If you would like to check the research: every source we used is documented in the bibliography.

Methods

For the project we took a design research approach, meaning that we would end up with an artefact that would solve the problem as oppose to a report that would state the problem.

Since we will be designing for the user it was important to use the methods that fit the human centered design methodology. We therefore empathized with the eventual user and created a persona that would represent our target audience.

Nicky parker is very good at meeting new people, but she doesn't know how to develop the connection. Since she doesn't use social media it is especially difficult now that she moved to a new place.



Nicky Parker
in relationship: no
Education: Environmental Studies
Occupation: Works at the local store
Location: UNI dormitories

Quote:
Lets hang

Goals:
- To graduate
- To enjoy
- maintain a deep connection
- create communication

Interests:
- swim
- Heavy metal
- vegan
- Loves to go out to parties (but not to host)
- Conversations with childhood friends and they are her main interaction

Frustations:
- Doing something that ends up not being rewarded
- Not knowing what is happening
- She does not like to talk for many hours
- maintain relationship
- can't pass the stage from superficial to deeper relationships

Motivations (1LS-SMS):
- Social Status: ***
- Social Comfort: **
- Fast (maybe cheap)
- Thrills: *****
- Privacy: *****
- Convenience: *****

Personality (1LS-SMS):
- Active: ***
- Stress: ***
- Happy: ***
- Confidence: ***
- Speed: ***
- Persistent: *****

Needs:
- Always be in action
- close friends
- control
- Change of scenery
- To feel comfortable to be herself

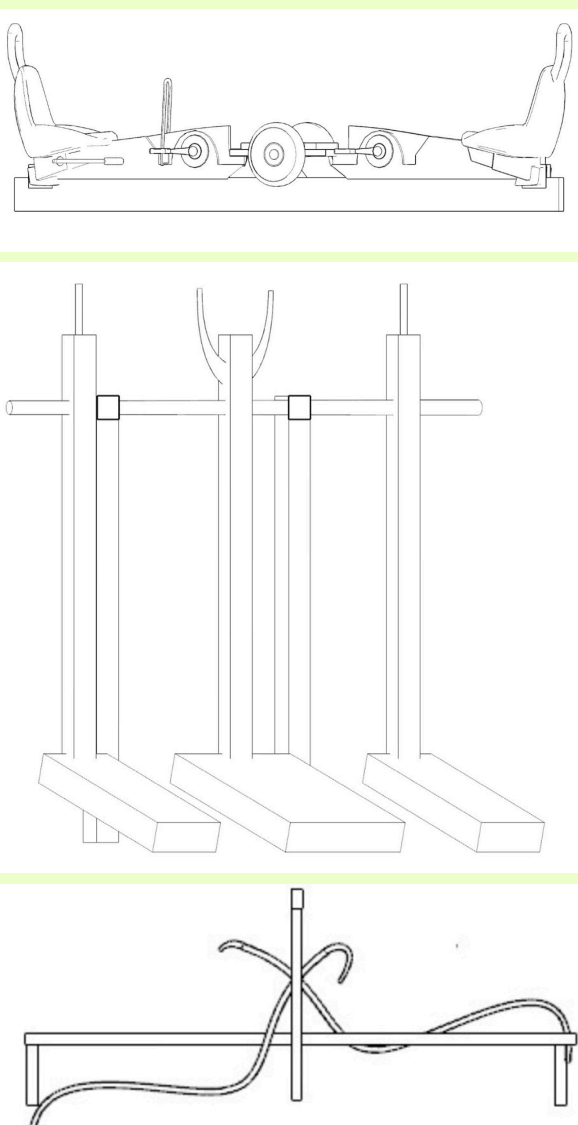
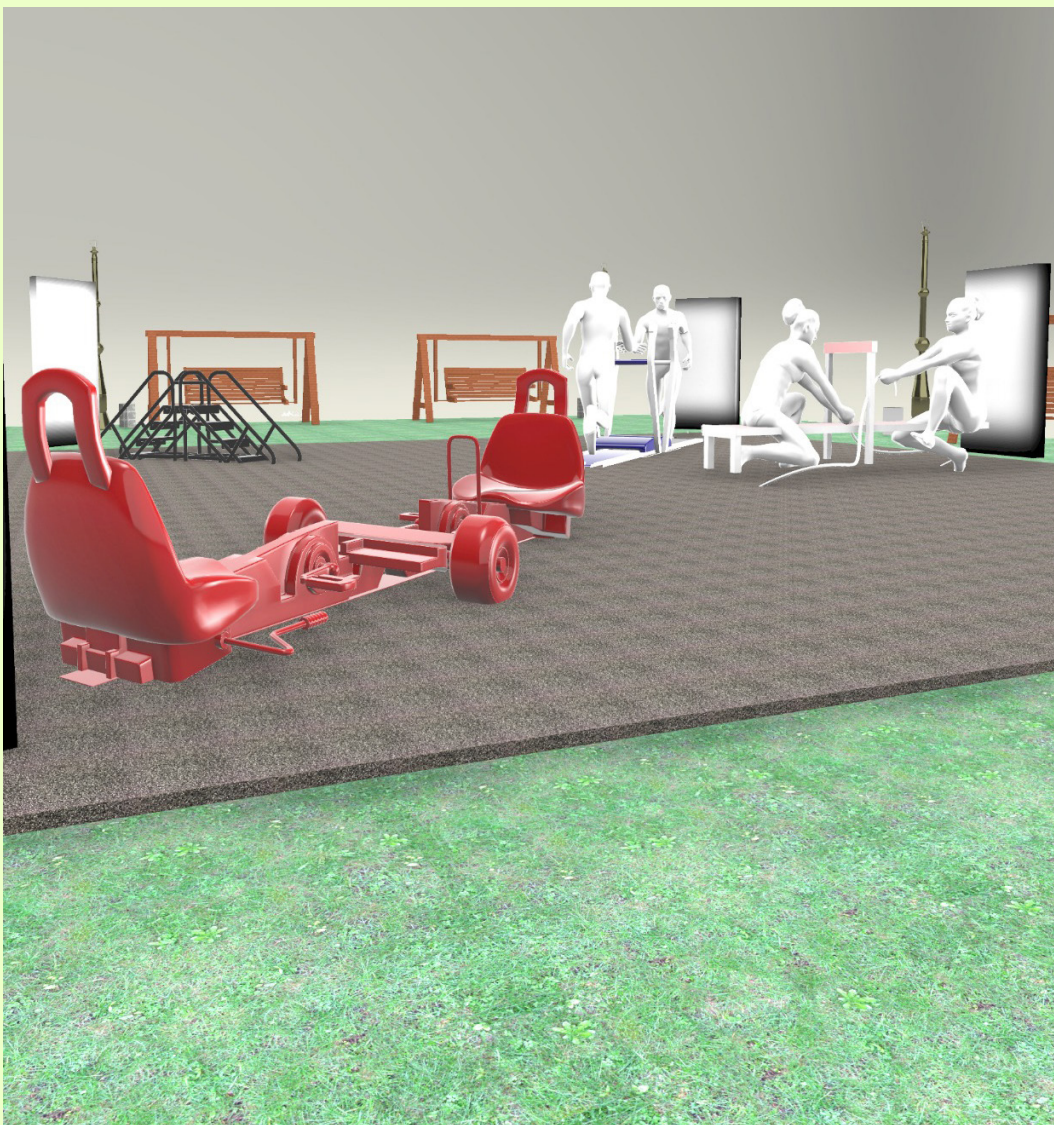
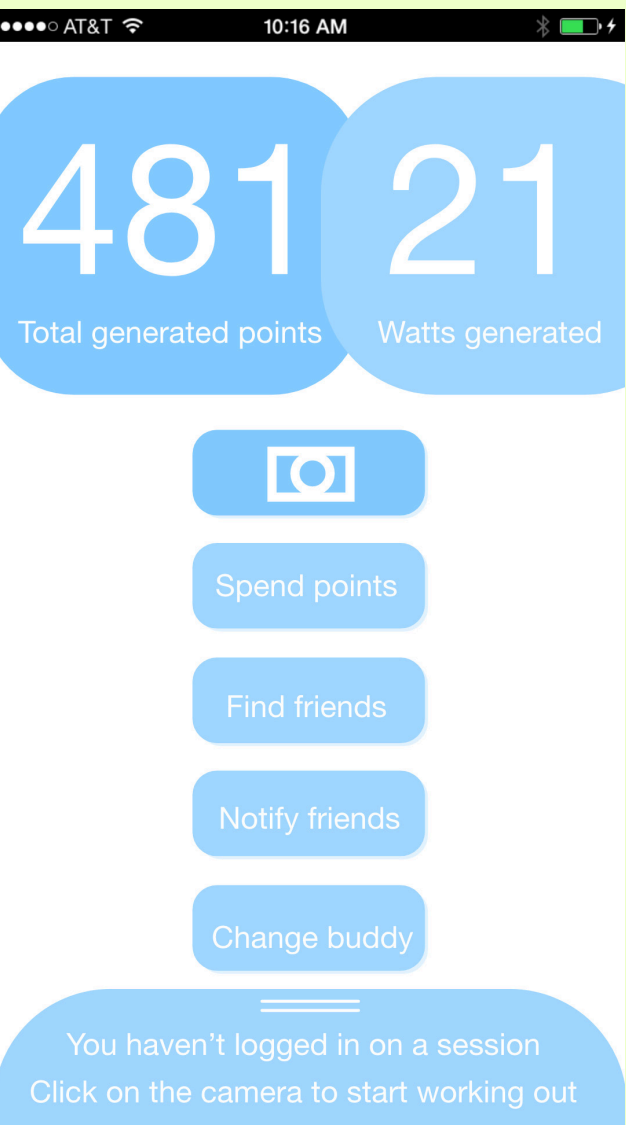
After a voting session we decided that when she didn't have anyone at home to talk to about her day. So we started coming up with ideas, eventually we combined different concepts and started to sketch out the form of all the different aspects. By sketching different ideas and presenting them to each other, we were able to narrow down our concept to an application and 3d model. Every step of the way we came back to Nicky and discussed if the concept still fitted to her wishes. When we were ready with the product we spoke with Jan-Wessel Hovingh UI\UX and Dr Ximena Schmidt who has an Expertise in sustainability, circular economy, system thinking, life cycle assessment. They provided feedback which we could then use in the

Results



We imagine a space that will force users to do a joint activity with an emphasis on eye contact. According to the physical statista council, based on 18.000 US respondents, Gen Z has a 59% participation rate when it comes to outdoor activities. Thats more than 39,5 million people in the US alone.

Research evidence (Kleinke, C. L. (1986) illustrates that physical activity, and associated processes, can contribute positively to mental health (with the obvious exceptions of over-training and training addiction) and have a positive effect on anxiety, depression, mood and emotion, self-esteem and psychological dysfunctionThe devices will be placed in a circular shape. Next to each set of devices will be a screen that shows the pace of progress, accumulation of reward points and suggestions for possible topics of conversation / common activities.

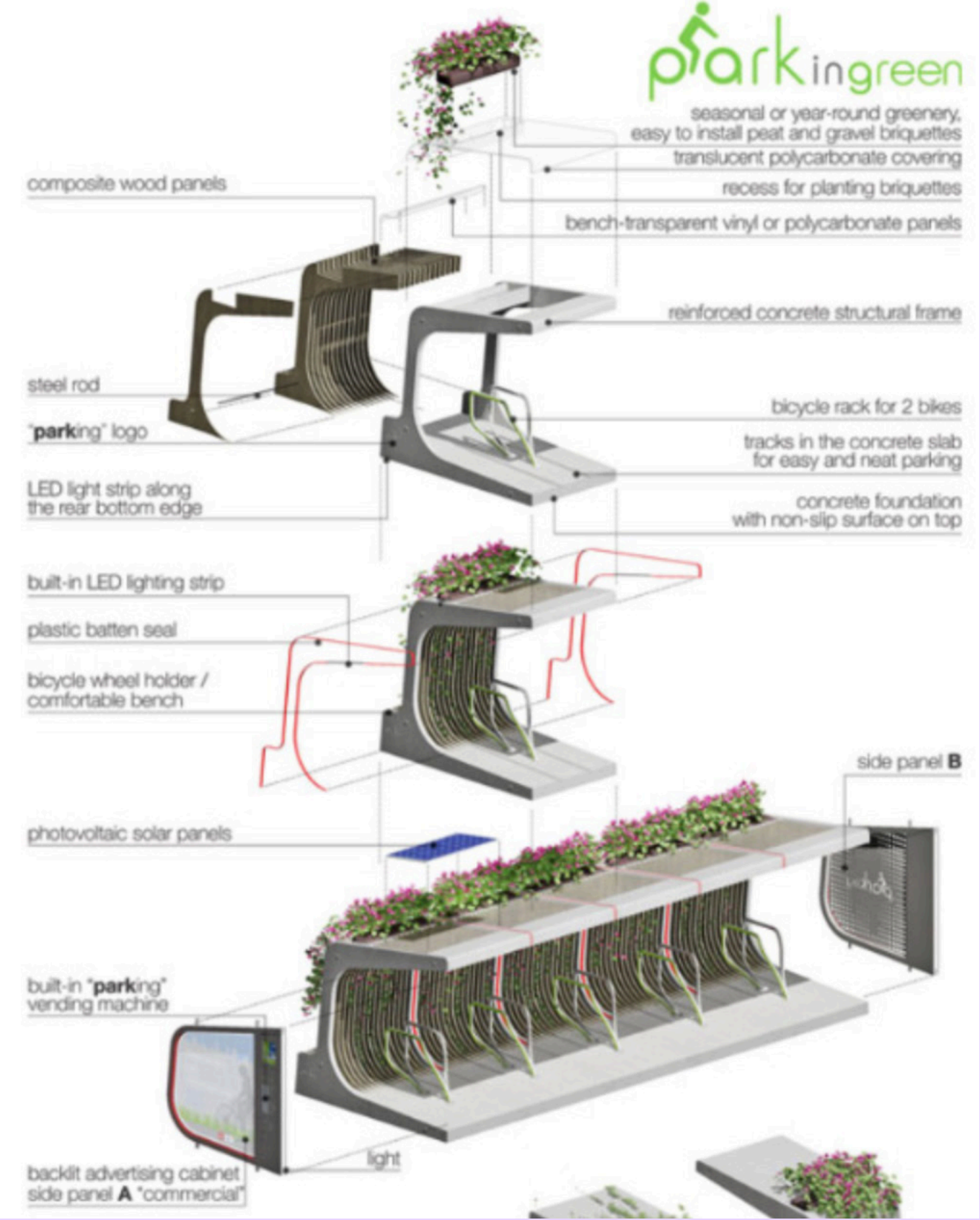
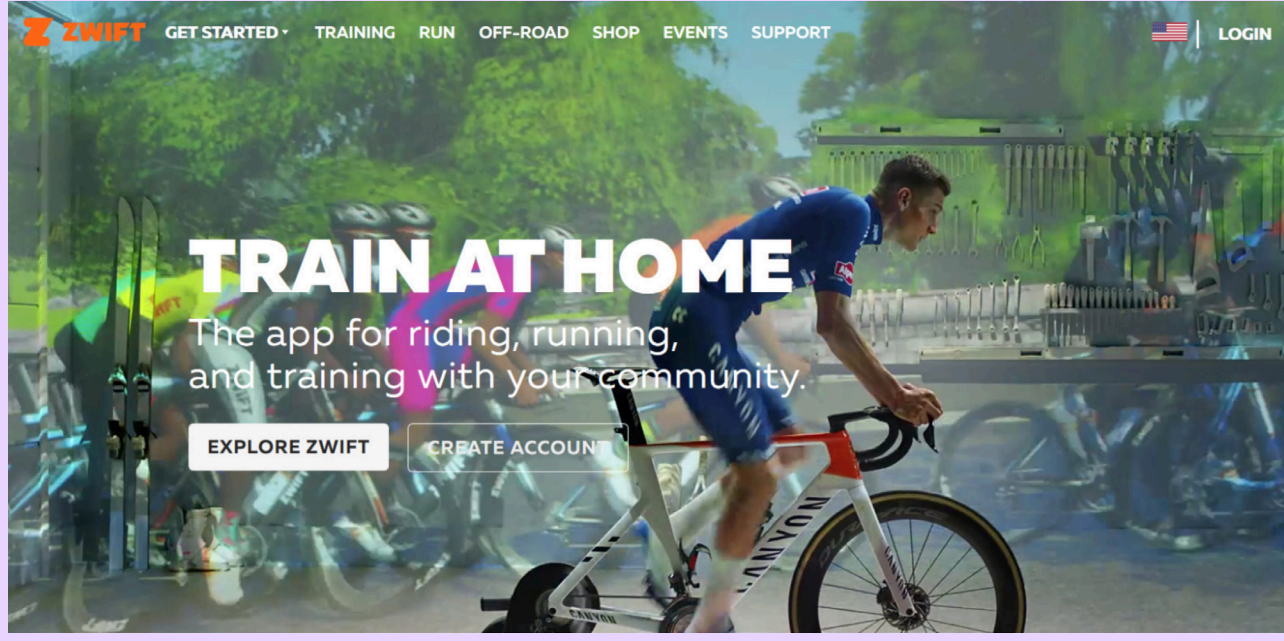


All devices are aimed for couple use and face each other to assist in the eye contact. It will be possible to create joint activities between the devices and thus accumulate extra activities and points by reaching synchronization. In terms of using the device, it will be connected to the mobile application: You log in, can invite friends, swap partners and call them to come and exercise with you and your group. The user can spend his or her accumulated reward points on multiple choices such as charity, mobile charging in place or displaying special lights on the screens.

To take a look at the application on your phone, scan the qr code on the right.



Inspiration



Advice

Lastly, here are some possibilities for future steps and developments of the product:

- Adding equipment that accommodates for disabled personnel.
- Adding equipment aimed at groups larger than two people
- Cooperation with environmental-friendly organizations and operations, such as animal shelters, tree planting, irrigation and more

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